

Design Director specialising in brand identity, visual systems, typography, and art direction, with 11 years of experience working across corporate, property, hospitality, and arts and cultural sectors. Recognised as AGDA Emerging Designer of the Year (2020, Distinction); now leading a studio delivering brand strategy and design for some of Australia’s largest institutional property and infrastructure clients, including Lendlease, Mirvac, Stockland, and CBUS Property.

Actively working at the intersection of traditional design craft and emerging technology, using Figma, AI tooling, and code-adjacent workflows (Cursor, Claude Code) to build more sophisticated design systems and expand what a small team can deliver. Builds every brand with a comprehensive digital presence from the start: UX wireframes, interaction design, and detailed developer briefs ensuring faithful implementation across web and digital platforms that are consistent with the wider print and environmental design ecosystem.

The approach is always strategy-led: every project begins with identifying the problem design can solve and the strategic insight that unlocks the solution. Ultimately, always in service of empathetic communication for the audience and customer.

Disciplines	Brand Identity & Visual Systems	Creative Direction
	Brand Strategy & Design Thinking	Environmental & Wayfinding Design
	Art Direction	Print & Publication Design
	Digital Design & UX Wireframing	Campaign, Communication Design & Brand Activation
	Language & Writing for Design	Team Leadership & Mentorship
	Typography, Grid Systems	Presenting & Public Speaking

Experience

Apr 2025 – Present	Design Director Studio ODEA, Brisbane, AU
Selected clients:	CBUS Property, Lendlease, Scentre Group, Stockland, Mirvac, Charter Hall Group, Dexis
	- Lead creative and strategic direction across a portfolio of brand identity, design systems, campaign, environmental, and digital design projects, spanning institutional property development, hospitality, and commercial sectors. - Manage and mentor the in-house design team, overseeing creative quality, professional development, and delivery from initial strategy through to execution and production. - Drive brand strategy at the client level: leading discovery, shaping briefs, identifying audience insights, and translating complex business goals into cohesive, scalable visual systems. - Design comprehensive UX wireframes and digital brand guidelines for every major identity project, with detailed developer briefs ensuring faithful implementation across web and digital platforms. - Integrating AI tooling and code-adjacent workflows (including Cursor and Claude Code) into the studio’s design systems practice, enabling more sophisticated output and expanded team capacity.
Oct 2024 – Apr 2025	Senior Designer Studio ODEA, Brisbane, AU
	- Delivered senior creative direction across brand identity and property campaign projects, working across strategy, concept development, and production. - Took on expanded client-facing and team leadership responsibilities ahead of formal promotion to Design Director.

Experience (cont.)

Jan 2024 –
Oct 2024

Design Lead (Acting)
Theola Agency, Brisbane, AU

Selected clients:

Vicinity Centres, The GPT Group, Dexus, Far East Consortium, Lendlease, Jones Lang LaSalle (JLL)

- Assumed creative leadership of the studio following the Creative Director's departure, leading the team and maintaining creative quality and client relationships without a replacement hire.
- This period of acting leadership led directly to the Design Director appointment at Studio ODEA.

Jan 2022 –
Jan 2024

Senior Designer
Theola Agency, Brisbane, AU

- Held creative oversight across all studio output: managing a freelance design team and leading projects from strategic concept through to final production across property campaigns, placemaking, and SMB brand work.
- Maintained direct client relationships and presented work on behalf of the studio across a portfolio of major institutional and commercial property clients.
- Recognised across multiple AGDA Award categories for work in Property Sales & Development, Print, Illustration, and Brand Identity (2022–2023 Finalists and Merits).

Jan 2021 –
Dec 2021

Senior Designer
Monogram Partners, Sydney, AU

Selected clients:

CBUS Property, Lendlease, Scentre Group, Stockland, Mirvac, Charter Hall Group

- Reported to the Executive Creative Director; led creative concept development for major residential property projects and co-presented directly to clients alongside the ECD.
- Provided mentorship and creative direction to the broader design team.
- AGDA Award Finalist, Print Catalogues & Brochures (2022).

Nov 2019 –
Dec 2021

Designer – Freelance
Hulsbosch/Houston Group/Alphabet Studio, Sydney, AU

Selected clients:

Qantas, Optus, eftpos, Coles, QMS Media, Bluescope Steel, 86400, Opera Queensland, Sydney Theatre Company, Sydney Festival, NSW State Government

- Worked across three agencies spanning the full range of Australian brand design, from major corporate consultancies to independent arts and cultural studios, demonstrating versatility across sector, scale, and creative register.
- At Hulsbosch and Houston Group: contributed to high-profile national rebranding projects for ASX-listed and household-name clients, working under senior creative direction on identity, campaign, and communications design.
- At Alphabet Studio: led digital, print, motion, environmental, event, and seasonal campaign design for an exclusively arts and cultural client roster, including Opera Queensland, Sydney Theatre Company, Belvoir Theatre, and Sydney Festival. Reported directly to Executive Creative Directors and led client presentations.
- Sydney Design Awards: Gold (2021), Transform Awards ANZ: Bronze (2021), Silver: Graphic Design – Identity and Branding, Corporate (2022).

Tools

Figma (Design, Slides, Make, Buzz), Adobe CC (InDesign, Illustrator, Photoshop, After Effects), Cursor, Claude Code, AI Tooling

Education

Bachelor of Design (Visual Communication), First Class Honours
University of Technology Sydney, 2015

Emma Sprouster

Design Director
Brisbane, Australia
Open to relocation to Seattle, WA

hello@emmasprouster.com
emmasprouster.com
linkedin.com/in/emmasprouster

Recognition

2025	AGDA Awards — Print & Publications	Merit
2024	AGDA Awards — Brand	Finalist
2023	AGDA Awards — Print Catalogues & Brochures	Finalist
2023	AGDA Awards — Property Sales & Development	Finalist
2023	AGDA Awards — Illustration for Design	Finalist
2022	AGDA Awards — Illustration for Design	Merit
2022	AGDA Awards — Brand Identity, Small Business	Merit
2022	AGDA Awards — Print Catalogues & Brochures	Finalist
2022	Transform Awards — Identity and Branding, Corporate	Silver
2021	Sydney Design Awards — Identity and Branding	Gold
2021	Transform Awards — Identity and Branding, Corporate	Bronze
2020	AGDA Awards — Emerging Designer of the Year	Distinction
2015	University of Technology, Sydney	Dean's List 3.75GPA
2015	UTS — Toynbee Wilson Typography Prize	Winner
2015	Australian Graduate of the Year Awards Design Institute of Australia	Finalist
2015	DIA — GOTYA Going Places Award (created by the judging panel in special recognition)	Winner
2014	International Society of Typographic Designers Student Assessment Scheme	Merit

Community & Leadership

Australian Graphic Design Association

NSW Councillor (2020–21), Junior Council (2015–2019, Chair 2019)

- Active contributor to Australia's peak graphic design professional body, supporting emerging designers and sector advocacy in their largest state chapter.

International Society of Typographic Designers (ISTD)

Membership, 2014–present

- Invited to become a full member of the ISTD after achieving a merit-level award in their Student Assessment Scheme.

University of Technology Sydney

Sessional Academic & Guest Lecturer (2015–19)

- Taught visual communication and design practice to undergraduate students, participated in first year academic portfolio reviews and presented lectures.